Having explored a number of ways to access configuration information programmatically from the appSettings file, we'll now circle back to where this chapter started: environments. You will see how different versions of appSettings.json can coexist to help you manage different configurations for different environments.

14.2.6 Environments

You should have noticed that the default project template includes two app settings files. One, which you have been working with, is simply named appSettings.json. The second, which is nested with the first in Visual Studio's Solution Explorer, is named appSettings.Development.json. This naming convention is used to enable you to specify different configuration values for different environments. The default configuration is held in the app settings file that does not include an environment within its filename. Any sections that appear in an environment-specific version of app settings take precedence over the content of the default file. So if you have a different SMTP server configuration for your development environment, you can add an SmtpSettings section to the appSettings.Development.json file, and the settings there will override the defaults when the environment is `Development`. Listing 14.18 shows an example of an alternative configuration that points to a local server that needs no authentication.

There's one important thing to note here: the `Credentials` properties are set to empty strings, so that the default values are overridden. If you were to declare the `Credentials` as an empty object or omit them altogether, the default values would be used.

Listing 14.18 Development-specific SMTP server configuration

```
"SmtpSettings": {
  "Host": "localhost",
```